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Rod Rosenstein submits letter of resignation to Trump

WASHINGTON (AP) — Deputy Attorney General Rod Rosenstein submitted his resignation Monday, ending a nearly two-year run defined by his appointment of a special counsel to investigate connections between President Donald Trump's campaign and Russia. His last day will be May 11. Rosenstein's departure had been expected since the confirmation of William Barr as attorney general. The White House nominated a replacement for the department's No. 2 slot weeks ago. Rosenstein intended to leave around mid-March but stayed on for the completion of special counsel Robert Mueller's Russia investigation. Mueller last month submitted his report to the Justice Department, and Rosenstein was part of a small group of department officials who reviewed the document and helped shape its public release.

Latest: Lawmakers adopt Holocaust resolution, discuss attack

California lawmakers adopted a resolution in honor of Holocaust Memorial Day and took a moment during Monday's ceremony to speak about this weekend's attack on a synagogue near San Diego. Assemblyman Jesse Gabriel, vice chairman of the California Legislative Jewish Caucus, said the state's Jewish community is alarmed by the "infusion of anti-Semitism into our political discourse." He emphasized that the Holocaust "didn't happen overnight" and that people should be aware of smaller deeds such as hateful rhetoric. A 19-year-old man has been charged with murder in Saturday's attack on Chabad of Poway. Authorities have described it as a hate crime.

Parents say synagogue suspect is part of 'history of evil'

POWAY, Calif. (AP) — The parents of a 19-year-old college student suspected of attacking a Southern California synagogue said Monday that they are shocked and saddened that "he is now part of the history of evil that has been perpetrated on Jewish people for centuries." John T. Earnest's parents said they raised him and his five siblings in a family, faith and community that rejected hate. "Our son's actions were informed by people we do not know, and ideas we do not hold," the parents said in a statement, which didn't include their names. A gunman on Saturday burst into the Chabad of Poway near San Diego on the last day of Passover, a major Jewish holiday that celebrates freedom, and opened fire with an assault-style rifle, killing a woman and wounding a rabbi and two others.

NRA's LaPierre fends off backlash, wins re-election as CEO

INDIANAPOLIS (AP) — Wayne LaPierre, the fiery public face of the National Rifle Association for decades, fended off a backlash inside the organization over its finances and direction, winning re-election Monday as the gun lobby's CEO. The move, announced on the NRA magazine's American Rifleman website, came during a closed-door meeting of the group's board of directors. It was unclear if the debate that has roiled the 5-million-member organization in recent weeks would still lead to significant changes in its operations. Board members did not immediately return messages for comment; their phones had been confiscated before entering the meeting room. The board also elected a slate of leaders, including Carolyn Meadows as president.

John Singleton, maker of 'Boyz N the Hood,' dies at 51

NEW YORK (AP) — Director John Singleton, who made one of Hollywood's most memorable debuts with the Oscar-nominated "Boyz N the Hood" and continued over the following decades to probe the lives of black communities in his native Los Angeles and beyond, has died. He was 51. Singleton's family said Monday that he died in Los Angeles,

surrounded by family and friends, after being taken off life support. Earlier this month, the director suffered a major stroke. Singleton was in his early 20s, just out of the University of Southern California's School of Cinematic Arts, when he wrote, directed and produced "Boyz N the Hood." Based on Singleton's upbringing and shot in his old neighborhood, the low-budget production starred Cuba Gooding Jr.

Far-right in Spain sweeps town with anti-migrant message

EL EJIDO, Spain (AP) — Surrounded by miles of greenhouses where migrant workers grow fruit and vegetables for the rest of Europe, this sleepy town on the sunbaked Mediterranean coast has become a beachhead for the arrival of the far-right in Spain, the latest country to be hit by the wave of nationalist populism sweeping the continent. El Ejido was where the upstart far-right Vox party made its most impressive gains during Sunday's national elections, with its promises to defend Spain's unity and quash the separatist push in northeastern Catalonia, while also railing against the women's movement and animal-rights activists who want to ban traditional Spanish bull-fighting.

Surge in US measles cases leads to extraordinary measures

NEW YORK (AP) — Quarantines in California. Fines in New York City. Orders for some people to avoid public places in Rockland County, New York. As an outbreak of measles surges across the United States — with 704 cases this year and counting — some local health officials are trying to deal with contagion in unvaccinated communities by turning to extraordinary police powers from the past. "Unfortunately, we are revisiting diseases from another generation," said Jason Schwartz, an assistant professor of health policy at the Yale School of Public Health. "And now we are revisiting public health responses from another generation" in instances where vaccination programs have fallen short, he said.

No arrests day after chaotic shooting attack in Baltimore

BALTIMORE (AP) — Baltimore police detectives are trying to figure out whether a chaotic shooting attack on a crowd enjoying a weekend cookout might be competition between underworld groups, a triggerman seeking vengeance or another kind of senseless strike. But one thing's for certain: In a city accustomed to gun violence, the Sunday afternoon shooting that killed one and wounded seven others in a gritty West Baltimore neighborhood barely stands out in a sea of similar shootings. "I think this weekend's shooting unfortunately exemplifies the kind of standard violence, quote-unquote, we're seeing in Baltimore," said Cassandra Crifasi, deputy director of the Center for Gun Policy and Research at Baltimore's Johns Hopkins University.

Defense: Cop shot woman after 'perfect storm' of events

MINNEAPOLIS (AP) — A Minneapolis police officer who shot and killed an unarmed woman who approached his squad car minutes after calling 911 was caught up in "a perfect storm" of events but "acted as he was trained," his attorney argued Monday. Prosecutors countered that Mohamed Noor was responsible for "a tragic event of his own making" in 2017 when he shot Justine Ruszczyk Damond, a dual U.S.-Australia citizen who had summoned police when she heard a possible rape in the alley behind her home. They urged jurors to find Noor guilty on all counts. The case went to the jury almost a month after jury selection began in a catastrophic shooting that prompted anger and disbelief in the U.S.

Beluga whale with Russian harness raises alarm in Norway

COPENHAGEN, Denmark (AP) — A beluga whale found with a tight harness that appeared to be Russian made has raised the alarm of Norwegian officials and prompted speculation that the animal may have come from a Russian military facility. Joergen Ree Wiig of the Norwegian Directorate of Fisheries says "Equipment St. Petersburg" is written on the harness strap, which features a mount for an action camera. He said Monday fishermen in Arctic Norway last week reported the tame white cetacean with a tight harness swimming around. On Friday, fisherman Joar Hesten, aided by the Ree Wiig, jumped into the frigid water to remove the harness.

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